

Build Your Own *Magnifica Humanitas* Study Assistant

No code. About ten minutes. Nothing to install.

This is the "you can do this yourself at home" version of the live demonstration. You will end up with an assistant that has read the whole encyclical and can find any passage in a second — always pointing you to the paragraph so you can read it yourself.

A word first, so it is never misunderstood: **this is a finding aid, not a teacher**. It shows you *where* the document speaks, in the document's own words. What the document *means* is the work of a theologian — and of your own prayer and study. Treat it like a very fast index, not an oracle.

Step 1 — Get the text

Go to **vatican.va**, open *Magnifica Humanitas*, and copy the full text (or save the page as a PDF / plain-text file). You will hand this file to the assistant in Step 3.

<https://www.vatican.va/content/leo-xiv/en/encyclicals/documents/20260515-magnifica-humanitas.html>

Step 2 — Choose one of these (any works)

- **ChatGPT** — chat.openai.com
- **Claude** — claude.ai
- **Gemini** — gemini.google.com

A free account is enough to try it. (The reusable versions in Step 4 need a paid plan.)

Step 3 — The easy way: one conversation

1. Start a new chat.
2. **Attach the encyclical file** (the paperclip / "+" button), or paste the text in.
3. Paste the instructions below as your **first message**, then start asking questions.



Instructions to paste:

You are my study assistant for one document: Pope Leo XIV's encyclical Magnifica Humanitas, which I have given you. Please follow these rules:

1. Answer **only** from the text I provided. Do not use outside knowledge, and do not add your own opinions or interpretation.
2. Whenever you tell me what the document says, **cite the paragraph number** (for example, "para. 16").
3. If the text does not address my question, **say so plainly** — do not guess.
4. If I ask for a judgement or an interpretation, gently remind me that you can only report what this document says, and that interpretation is for a theologian.
5. Keep answers short, respectful, and neutral, and point me to the paragraph so I can read it myself.

That's the whole trick. No database, no plugins — the document is short enough for the assistant to hold in mind all at once.

Step 4 — The reusable way (optional)

If you'd like a permanent assistant you can return to without re-pasting anything:

- **In ChatGPT (Plus):** Explore GPTs → **Create** → upload the file under *Knowledge*, paste the instructions above into the *Instructions* box, name it, and save.
- **In Claude (Pro/Team):** create a **Project**, add the file to the project knowledge, paste the instructions into the project's custom instructions, and use it any time.

Questions worth trying

- Does the encyclical say that technology is neutral?
 - Does it say artificial intelligence is evil?
 - What image frames the whole document?
 - What does it say about autonomous weapons?
 - What is the "technocratic paradigm"?
 - What does it say about human work?
 - *(Now ask something the document doesn't cover — and watch it tell you so. That honesty is the point.)*
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Two honest cautions

- **It can be confidently wrong.** If you remove the document, or ask about something outside it, it may invent a plausible-sounding answer. That is why the rules above force it to cite paragraphs and to admit when the text is silent. Always check against the real paragraph.
 - **It is not the Magisterium.** It is a search tool that happens to speak in sentences. The encyclical itself, on vatican.va, is the authority — this only helps you find your way around it.
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Example 1:

Prompt: *Enumerate Reasons some are reassured about AI.*

Response:

Based on the "Encyclical Letter of His Holiness Leo XIV Magnifica Humanitas (15 May 2026).pdf", the document notes several positive capabilities and promises of AI and technology that offer reassurance or benefits:

- **Solving Problems and Connecting People:** Technology has the power to heal, educate, connect people, and protect the environment (para. 9).
- **Convenience and Efficiency:** The speed and simplicity of accessing information, media, complex analyses, and practical assistance make everyday life easier (para. 100).
- **Improving Services:** AI provides clear gains in efficiency and has the potential to improve various services (para. 101).
- **Supporting Mutual Care:** Technology can assist in daily life by providing tools to help anticipate and organize tasks (para. 114).
- **Alleviating Suffering:** Technological progress and human creative intelligence can be embraced when they alleviate suffering and unlock new, positive possibilities (para. 126, para. 129).
- **Workplace Improvements:** AI promises to boost productivity by taking over mundane tasks, and it is highly desirable for technology to relieve humans of arduous, repetitive, or dangerous work (para. 150, para. 152).
- **Civilian Protection:** In a defense context, AI has the capacity to enhance the protection and defense of civilians (para. 183).

Example 2:

Prompt: *Enumerate reasons many are concerned about AI*

Response:

Here is an enumeration of the primary reasons for concern found in the document:

- **Erosion of Judgment and Relationships:** The ease of AI can weaken personal creativity and judgment, while simulated AI communication risks diminishing the desire for genuine human connections (para. 100).
- **Environmental Harm:** AI systems demand massive amounts of energy, water, and natural resources, negatively impacting the environment (para. 101).
- **Loss of Human Compassion in Decision-Making:** Delegating sensitive choices—such as employment or credit—to opaque algorithms removes mercy and accountability, often masking biases as objective neutrality (para. 102, para. 103, para. 105).
- **Concentration of Unregulated Power:** Control over AI is largely held by a few private entities, which can manipulate democratic processes, shape consumption, and widen global inequality without public oversight (para. 5, para. 95, para. 108).
- **Threats to Truth:** AI serves as a powerful amplifier for disinformation, manipulating facts and images in ways that erode social trust and democratic life (para. 132).
- **Dangers to Youth:** Unsupervised digital exposure negatively impacts minors' mental health and exposes them to addiction, cyberbullying, grooming, and exploitation (para. 141).
- **Unemployment and Worker Degradation:** The rapid integration of AI threatens massive job losses, new forms of precarious labor, and the de-skilling and automated surveillance of workers (para. 150, para. 151).
- **Surveillance and Social Control:** Massive data collection allows for behavioral profiling and manipulation, functioning as a form of social control that undermines freedom (para. 171).
- **New Forms of Slavery:** The AI economy relies on hidden exploitation, including underpaid data labelers and hazardous mining for tech resources, often involving vulnerable populations and minors (para. 173).
- **Lethal Autonomous Weapons:** AI in military systems lowers the moral threshold for violence, makes conflict more impersonal, and dangerously removes human conscience and responsibility from lethal decisions (para. 197, para. 198).